01 / Company and service overview

CloudHarbor is a fictional company. All prices, policies, names and examples in this handbook are synthetic test data, not real service commitments.

CloudHarbor provides a document knowledge service for teams that work with operating manuals, onboarding guides, contracts and internal policies. Users upload searchable PDF files, organize them into workspaces and ask natural-language questions. Answers include source page references so users can compare an answer with the original passage. CloudHarbor is not DocMind; this fictional handbook is a sample document intended for retrieval testing.

Release and policy scope

This is handbook version 1.4, effective October 1, 2026. It replaces version 1.3, which was effective July 1, 2026. The current policy is the policy stated in version 1.4. The workspace region, billing plan and contractual exceptions can change which rules apply. An exception must be recorded in a signed order form; a verbal promise or support chat is not an approved exception.

Service responsibilities

The service has three operational teams. Customer Operations owns account onboarding and billing questions. Platform Operations owns ingestion queues, availability and incident response. Trust Operations owns access reviews, deletion requests and security investigations. The support coordinator for this fictional handbook is Mira Desai. The platform duty manager is Leon Park. Neither person has a public phone number in this document.

Important distinctions

An uploaded document is not necessarily ready for questions. Upload acceptance means the file was stored and a processing job was created. Readiness requires extraction, chunking, embedding and indexing to finish. A source citation indicates where the supporting passage appeared; it does not independently prove that the source is accurate. Where source material is incomplete or contradictory, the assistant should explain the limitation instead of inventing a policy.

The handbook does not specify company valuation, employee salaries, founding date, office street addresses or a mobile application release date. Readers should not infer those facts from the policies below.

02 / Plans, limits and pricing

CloudHarbor offers three subscription plans. Prices are in US dollars, before tax. Monthly subscription prices below include the listed seats; extra seat prices apply only when the active seat count exceeds the included seats. A seat is an active member with Owner, Administrator, Editor or Viewer access. Suspended users do not count as active seats.

Limit or price	Starter	Team	Enterprise
Monthly base price	$49	$199	Custom order form
Included active seats	3	15	Negotiated
Additional seat / month	$12	$9	Negotiated
Uploaded PDFs / month	100	1,000	Negotiated
Queries / month	2,000	20,000	Negotiated
Maximum PDF size	20 MB	50 MB	100 MB
Maximum pages per PDF	200	500	1,000
Storage allowance	5 GB	50 GB	Negotiated

Capacity and plan enforcement

A PDF must satisfy both the file-size limit and the page-count limit. A Team-plan document with 450 pages and a 52 MB file size is rejected because the size exceeds 50 MB. A Starter-plan document with 210 pages and a 10 MB file size is rejected because it exceeds 200 pages. Splitting a file into smaller PDFs is allowed, but every resulting upload counts toward the monthly document allowance.

Monthly upload and query allowances reset at 00:00 UTC on the first day of each calendar month. Unused allowance does not roll over. Query requests refused for malformed input do not consume query allowance. A valid query that returns an abstention does consume one query because retrieval was performed. Document storage allowance is measured independently of monthly upload allowance.

Annual prepayment receives a 15% discount on base subscription charges only. Additional seats, taxes and separately negotiated services are excluded from that discount. Annual subscriptions do not increase monthly usage allowances. Enterprise pricing must be read from the signed order form; the handbook supplies no universal Enterprise price.

03 / Onboarding and access roles

Onboarding begins when an Owner creates a workspace, selects a region and confirms the billing plan. The Owner must accept the service terms before inviting users. After activation, the Administrator uploads a small searchable PDF and verifies that its status becomes ready. A Viewer then asks a question and checks the source citation. This smoke test confirms the workflow without establishing load capacity or disaster-recovery performance.

Role	Allowed actions	Restrictions
Owner	Manage billing; transfer ownership; delete workspace; all Administrator actions	Ownership transfer requires the recipient to accept
Administrator	Invite members; assign Editor/Viewer roles; configure retention; upload and delete documents	Cannot transfer ownership or delete workspace
Editor	Upload documents; ask questions; delete own uploads	Cannot manage billing, membership or workspace retention
Viewer	List permitted documents; ask questions; view citations	Cannot upload or delete documents

Regional choice and access review

The initial region is either US East or EU West. Administrators cannot switch an existing workspace region in place. A region change requires creating a destination workspace, exporting permitted source files, importing them into the destination and verifying access before deleting the original. Historical query logs are not included in the standard export.

Access reviews occur every 90 days. The Owner confirms that each active member still needs access. When a member leaves the organization, an Administrator must suspend that member within four hours of receiving the departure notice. Suspension prevents new API calls and UI access; it does not delete the former member's uploaded documents.

Service accounts and invitation expiry

Service accounts must have named owners, and their API keys must be stored in an approved secrets manager. Shared personal accounts are prohibited. Invitations expire after seven days. An expired invitation must be reissued; changing a member's role does not extend invitation validity. An Owner may appoint up to two billing contacts, but a billing contact without workspace membership does not receive document access.

04 / PDF ingestion and recovery

An upload request stores the original PDF in object storage and creates a document record with status pending. The API places the document identifier and storage key on the ingestion queue. A worker retrieves the PDF using that key, extracts page text, creates overlapping chunks, obtains embeddings and writes chunks and document metadata to the retrieval database. The status then changes to ready. Uploaded files may be processed by a worker on a different machine from the API.

Processing rules

CloudHarbor uses chunks of up to 500 words with 50 words of overlap. Chunks do not cross page boundaries. Each chunk carries its document identifier, page number and chunk index. Blank pages generate no text chunks but still count toward the document page total. A one-page document containing 950 words produces three chunks: words 1-500, words 451-950, and words 901-950. The final short chunk is retained.

The embedding vector has 3,072 dimensions. Original file storage is separate from embedding storage. PDFs protected by a password are rejected unless the password is removed before upload. Scanned PDFs with no extractable text are unsupported in version 1.4 because OCR is not implemented. An empty extraction result is reported as no searchable text rather than treated as evidence for answering.

Retries and idempotency

A failed processing job permits three retries after delays of 10, 30 and 60 seconds. A scheduler is required to execute delayed retries. The worker job timeout is 1,800 seconds, and normal shutdown permits up to 1,860 seconds for the current job to finish. A forced process kill bypasses normal shutdown. Abandoned jobs are recovered after queue maintenance detects them; recovery is not instantaneous.

Retrying the same job reuses its document identifier and skips already stored chunks with the same page number and chunk index. Final chunk totals include both previously committed and newly created chunks. Uploading the same PDF again creates a new document identifier and is not covered by job-level deduplication. Corrupt files fail processing and are not made queryable.

05 / Retrieval, answers and citations

A question is embedded and compared with stored chunk vectors using cosine similarity. In parallel, BM25 keyword search ranks text chunks by lexical relevance. Reciprocal Rank Fusion combines candidate rankings using a constant of 60: each candidate contributes 1 divided by 60 plus its one-based rank from each ranked list in which it appears. The fused score measures ranking preference, not calibrated answer confidence.

Evidence qualification

The default minimum cosine similarity is 0.50. An Administrator can tune the threshold after evaluating labeled relevant and irrelevant questions. Only candidates with a known cosine score at or above the threshold are supplied as answer evidence. A score exactly equal to 0.50 qualifies; a score of 0.49 does not. Keyword-only candidates with no cosine score do not qualify under the conservative version 1.4 policy, even when their BM25 score is high.

If no evidence qualifies, the assistant returns: "I don't have enough information in the provided documents to answer this question." The assistant must not answer from general knowledge when a fact is absent from the sources. Similar wording in a retrieved passage is not sufficient if that passage does not contain the requested fact. The threshold is a heuristic and still requires calibration; it is not a guarantee that every generated answer is correct.

Queries and page references

A query may optionally name one document identifier. When supplied, retrieval is restricted to that document. The requested result count k must be an integer between 1 and 50 inclusive. An invalid UUID, fractional k or out-of-range k is rejected before embedding. A valid identifier for a missing document returns not found. A document still processing cannot be queried.

The citation page number is the physical one-based PDF page number, not an internal chapter label. A fact assembled from two pages should cite both. Streamed responses send citation metadata first, text tokens next and a done event last. A non-streaming response contains the answer, citations and an abstaining flag. This flag reports whether evidence qualification refused generation; it is not a measure of answer completeness.

06 / Security and regional boundaries

CloudHarbor authenticates each request and enforces workspace membership before listing documents, retrieving chunks or generating an answer. Authorization must be applied to both document metadata and text retrieval. A random-looking document identifier is not an access-control mechanism. Users cannot retrieve a document from another workspace merely by knowing its identifier.

Data handling

Traffic uses TLS 1.2 or newer. Stored files and database backups use AES-256 encryption. Production credentials are kept in a secrets manager and are not committed to source control. Application API keys rotate every 90 days; suspected compromise triggers immediate revocation and replacement. An administrator must not paste API keys, private documents or unredacted customer identifiers into public support channels.

Default application logs include request identifiers, route names, response codes and timings. Full document text, full question text and generated answers are excluded from default application logs. A customer may authorize a temporary diagnostic capture lasting no more than 24 hours. Trust Operations must approve it, define the capture scope and record the scheduled deletion time. Diagnostic capture is not enabled automatically by a support ticket.

Regional commitments and exceptions

US East and EU West workspaces store original PDFs and retrieval databases in their selected region. Embedding and generation may use an external provider whose processing location depends on the provider configuration. Therefore a regional storage choice alone is not a promise that all model processing remains in that region. Enterprise customers requiring region-restricted model processing need a signed configuration addendum before onboarding.

Privileged access to customer data requires a ticket, a stated purpose and approval from Trust Operations. Emergency access expires after one hour and is audited. The service does not claim a particular external security certification in this handbook. Questions about named certifications cannot be answered from these pages.

07 / Retention, deletion and exports

By default, original PDFs and searchable chunks are retained until a user deletes the document or a workspace retention rule expires. Administrators may configure automatic document retention between 30 and 365 days. Retention age is measured from initial upload time, not the most recent query or retry. Changing the rule applies to existing documents; documents already older than the new limit become eligible for deletion on the next daily retention run.

Data class	Retention or deletion rule
Original PDF and chunks	Removed from active systems within 24 hours of a valid deletion request
Query audit metadata	30 days; excludes full question and answer text
Security audit events	365 days
Backups	Rolling 14-day retention; no immediate selective deletion
Temporary diagnostic captures	At most 24 hours; approved scope only

Deletion process

A deletion request first marks the document unavailable for new queries. The deletion worker then removes active object-storage files, vector chunks and the document record within 24 hours. Copies may remain in existing backups until those backups expire, at most 14 days later. Restoring an old backup requires replaying deletion tombstones before reopening query access so deleted content does not become visible again.

A legal hold overrides automatic retention and ordinary deletion for the held records. Trust Operations records the hold scope and release authority. Users are informed that deletion is blocked by a hold where disclosure is permitted. The handbook does not specify how long every legal hold lasts; its duration depends on the recorded hold decision.

Export scope

Owners and Administrators may export original PDFs and document metadata. Standard exports exclude embeddings, model prompts, generated-answer history and historical query logs. Region migration uses this same export scope. A deleted file cannot be included in a new active-system export. Backup retention does not create a self-service undelete option for customers.

08 / Support and incident response

Support severity describes service impact, not the customer's subscription price. A billing question is not an availability incident. Initial response means acknowledging the issue and assigning an owner; it is not a promised resolution time. Support response targets below apply to Team and Enterprise workspaces. Starter support is handled within two business days without a severity-based response guarantee.

Severity	Definition	Initial response	Update cadence
P1	All users unable to upload or query	15 minutes, 24/7	Every 30 minutes
P2	Major feature degraded; workaround exists	1 hour, 24/7	Every 2 hours
P3	Limited issue or general assistance	1 business day	Daily on business days

Incident actions

The incident commander is the on-duty Platform Operations lead. During a P1, the commander opens an incident record, assigns a communications owner and checks API errors, database connectivity, queue backlog, worker heartbeats and external model-provider failures. Restarting every component without diagnosing the failure is not the standard first action. A healthy Redis connection alone does not establish that ingestion workers are alive.

A provider outage may allow uploads to be accepted while embedding jobs wait or retry. Document status remains pending or processing until indexing succeeds. Support must distinguish upload acceptance from readiness in customer updates. Queue growth is a signal to investigate; it is not proof that adding workers will solve an external provider quota limit.

Follow-up and availability

A P1 incident review is due within three business days of recovery. It records impact, timeline, contributing factors and follow-up owners. The Team availability target is 99.5% per calendar month. Enterprise availability and service credits are specified only in the signed order form. Planned maintenance announced at least 48 hours in advance is excluded from the Team availability calculation. This handbook gives no fixed universal incident-resolution deadline.

09 / Billing and worked examples

Monthly subscriptions renew on the calendar day the workspace activated. Usage counters still reset on the first of each month, so billing renewal and usage reset are different events. If the activation day does not exist in a month, renewal occurs on that month's final day. Invoices are due within 15 calendar days. Taxes are additional and depend on the billing address; no tax rate is specified here.

Example A: extra seats

Orchid Analytics has a monthly Team workspace with 18 active members. Team includes 15 seats and charges $9 per additional seat per month. Three additional seats cost $27, so the monthly base-plus-seat charge is $226 before tax. Suspending two members leaves 16 active seats; the charge then becomes $208 at the next renewal. Mid-cycle seat removals do not produce an immediate refund.

Example B: annual base discount

An annual Team base subscription is calculated as $199 multiplied by 12, then reduced by 15%. The undiscounted base is $2,388 and the prepaid discounted base is $2,029.80 before tax. If 18 seats remain active for the full annual term, the three additional seats cost $324 across 12 months without the base discount. The combined base-plus-extra-seat charge is $2,353.80 before tax. These examples assume no seat changes and no custom order-form amendments.

Plan changes and cancellation

Upgrades take effect immediately and are prorated for the remaining billing period. Downgrades take effect at the next renewal after storage, document sizes and active seats fit the destination plan. Canceling stops the next renewal but preserves access through the already paid period. Canceling a subscription does not itself delete the workspace or its documents; retention and deletion rules on page 7 still apply.

Duplicate charges confirmed by Customer Operations are refunded in full. Ordinary monthly subscription charges are not refunded merely because usage was low. Annual early-termination refunds require an explicit term in the signed order form; there is no blanket refund percentage in this handbook. Payment-card details and bank account numbers are intentionally absent from this sample.

10 / Operating scenarios and roadmap

Scenario: regional migration

A Team workspace stored in US East wants to move to EU West. The Owner creates an EU West destination workspace. An Administrator exports original PDFs and metadata, imports them, checks member permissions and waits for indexing to complete before testing questions. The old workspace is deleted only after the destination is verified. Historical query logs are not transferred in the standard export. Active-system deletion takes up to 24 hours, and backup copies may remain for up to 14 days.

Scenario: ambiguous policy question

A user asks whether canceled annual subscriptions always receive a refund. The billing policy does not grant that right; annual early-termination refunds depend on the signed order form. The assistant should explain the dependency and avoid inventing a percentage or promising an automatic refund. If the order form is not uploaded, its private terms cannot be retrieved from this handbook.

Scenario: incident plus workload spike

An external embedding provider begins rejecting requests while 40 PDFs are queued. Platform Operations checks the provider error and quota before increasing worker replicas. Additional workers may increase failed provider calls without improving throughput. Delayed retry scheduling must remain enabled. Customers are told that uploads can be accepted while documents remain unavailable for questions. Once embedding resumes, worker processing can complete and indexing status can change to ready.

Roadmap and evaluation

The next planned capabilities are OCR for scanned PDFs, improved keyword-only evidence evaluation and a labeled question set for tuning abstention. These are planned capabilities, not features available in version 1.4. No release dates are committed in this document. Evaluation should separately measure retrieval relevance, citation accuracy, answer factuality, abstention behavior and processing recovery. A count of passing regression tests is not an answer-accuracy percentage.

For demonstration, select a question with a direct answer in a table, a question requiring an exception, a calculation that combines price and seat limits, and a question whose answer is absent. Record the actual question, document identifier, returned answer and physical page citations. Do not treat a plausible answer about an absent fact as a successful demonstration.